

Data Classification Policy

Policy DC-002 - Information Classification and Handling

Organization: Northstar Financial Services (NFS)

Classification: INTERNAL - TRAINING

Effective date: September 2026

1. PUBLIC

Information approved for public disclosure. No confidentiality restriction.

2. INTERNAL

Routine business information intended for NFS personnel and authorized partners. External disclosure requires a business purpose.

3. CONFIDENTIAL

Sensitive business, customer, employee, financial, contractual or security information. Access is need-to-know. Approved encryption and controlled third-party processing are mandatory.

4. RESTRICTED

Highest sensitivity, including authentication secrets, cryptographic private keys, certain regulated records and highly sensitive security material. External AI processing is prohibited unless a specific written exception is approved by the CISO and Legal.

5. AI handling

Public and Internal data may be used with approved AI services according to the AI Governance Policy. Confidential data requires enterprise contractual protections, no provider training on NFS content and approved retention. Restricted data must not be submitted to external generative AI services by default.

6. Examples

Customer support transcripts containing personal data are Confidential. Public product brochures are Public. Internal operating procedures are Internal unless they expose sensitive security controls. API secrets and private keys are Restricted.